



Old Bridge Township School District

Curriculum & Instruction Department

Course: 7th Grade ELA

Department: English/Language Arts

Term: Full Year

Board Approval	Committee Members	Supervisor	Notes
9/24/2024	Gina Simon	Rocco Celentano	

MISSION STATEMENT

Recognizing that each person has an inherent worth, it is the mission of the Old Bridge Public Schools to empower each student to learn to achieve success and to become a confident, productive member of a pluralistic, global society prepared to face the challenges of the 21st Century.

BELIEFS

- Learning is a lifelong process.
- All children can learn.
- Education is a shared responsibility among the schools, the child, the family, and the community.
- All students are entitled to a safe, supportive learning environment.
- Self-esteem is necessary for successful learning.
- The development of curriculum is an ongoing and cyclical process.
- The district should provide a dynamic curriculum that recognizes our students' various needs and learning styles.
- An appreciation of the arts and humanities enhances the education of the whole child.
- All students should be taught to appreciate and respect the cultural differences in our society.
- All students are worthy of educational opportunity, respect, tolerance, and fairness.
- Schools should prepare students to function successfully in society.
- All children should be encouraged to rise to their highest level of achievement.

AFFIRMATIVE ACTION STATEMENT

The Old Bridge Township Public Schools provides equal educational opportunities for all students, including equal access to all school facilities, programs, equipment, staff services, financial resources, courses, or activities, and other benefits regardless of race, color, creed, religion, sex, ancestry, national origin, social, economic or academic status or physical handicap.

PHILOSOPHY

The Old Bridge Township Public School District's English Language Arts (ELA) Program provides students with authentic, meaningful experiences that will enable students to grow and develop intellectually, emotionally, and socially. Instructional practices are student-centered, promoting a commitment to life-long learning by developing students' speaking, listening, writing, reading, representative, and viewing skills. The teacher establishes a language-rich, interactive environment that provides strong support for literacy learning and surrounds the children with a wide variety of high-quality literature.

The ELA Program utilizes a balanced approach to literacy, integrating reading, writing, speaking, and listening throughout the curriculum. Reading comprehension is essential to continuing intellectual development. In addition, the Old Bridge Middle School ELA program requires the incorporation of research and comprehension strategies.

Differentiated instruction recognizes and supports individual learning styles, developmental readiness, and cultural differences, enabling all students to experience success. Library and research skills are integral to student experiences in all grade levels. Through integrated language experiences, students will strive to become independent readers, writers, and critical thinkers. Most importantly, students will acquire the skills to "read to learn," which is essential for becoming lifelong learners and independent writers.

PREFACE

Reading	• The standards require the progressive development of reading comprehension so that students advancing through the grades can gain more from whatever they read. • Through reading a diverse array of classic and contemporary literature, as well as challenging informational texts in a range of subjects, students are expected to build knowledge, gain insights, explore possibilities, and broaden their perspective. • The standards mandate certain critical types of content for all students, including classic myths and stories from around the world, foundational U.S. documents, seminal works of American literature, and current events.
Writing	• The ability to write logical arguments based on substantive claims, sound reasoning, and relevant evidence is a cornerstone of the writing standards, with opinion writing-a basic form of argument-extending down into the earliest grades. • Research: both short, focused projects (such as those commonly required in the workplace) and longer-term in-depth research is emphasized throughout the standards but most prominently in the writing strand since a written analysis and presentation of findings is so often critical.

Speaking and Listening	• The standards require the students gain, evaluate, and present increasingly complex information, ideas, and evidence through listening and speaking as well as through media. • An important focus of the speaking and listening standards is academic discussion in one-on-one, small-group, and whole-class settings. Formal presentations are one important way such talk occurs, but so is the more informal discussion that takes place as students collaborate to answer questions, build understanding, and solve problems.
Language	• The standards expect that students will grow their vocabularies through a mix of conversations, direct instruction, and reading. • The standards recognize that students must be able to use formal English in their writing and speaking but that they must also be able to make informed, skillful choices among the many ways to express themselves through language. • Vocabulary and conventions are treated in their own strand not because skills in these areas should be handled in isolation but because their use extends across reading, writing, speaking, and listening.
Media and Technology	• Just as media and technology are integrated in school and life in the twenty-first century, skills related to media use (both critical analysis and production of media) are integrated throughout the standards.

Old Bridge Pacing Calendar

Marking Period 1		Marking Period 2	
Reading and Analyzing Elements of Literature and Narrative Writing		Poetry and Drama Literary Analysis	
1	Narrative Text Structure (plot, central ideas, characterization, theme development)	1	Poetry—craft and structure, figurative language, symbolism, theme, sound devices
2	Summarizing and Close-Reading	2	Elements of Drama—stage directions, dialogue, literary devices (allusion, flashback, foreshadowing, irony, symbolism, etc.
3	Open-Ended Responses (OERs) and Paragraph Structure	3	Five-Paragraph Essay Structure (including thesis writing, direct citation, MLA formatting)
4	Original Text-Based Narrative Construction (short stories) – plot, imagery, dialogue, figurative language	4	Theme Development Essays—determining themes and tracking development throughout text; author’s purpose
		5	Compare and Contrast Analysis of multiple characters, themes, texts, structures, etc.

Marking Period 3		Marking Period 4	
Informational Text Analysis & Research		Cumulative Review and Comparison of All Genres	
1	Informational Text Structures & Reading Comprehension	1	Fiction and Non-Fiction Compare and Contrast
2	Citing Multiple Sources (MLA Format)	2	Theme Development
3	Summary Writing, Paraphrasing & Avoiding Plagiarism	3	Literary Analysis Revisited
4	Research Papers (Informational Essays Utilizing Multiple Sources)	4	Informational Text Analysis Revisited
5	Argumentative Essays and Debates Utilizing Research, Claims and Counterclaims	5	MLA Format and Works Cited

Core Instructional Resources and Materials (Including Varied Levels of Text)
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • StudySync ELA Grade 7. McGraw Hill. 2015 (one class set of 30 textbooks per teacher) • https://connected.mcgraw-hill.com/connected/dashboard.do StudySync online access per teacher and per student. • McDougal Littell, ed. <i>Literature</i>. Evanston, IL: McDougal, 2008. Print. • Hiranandani, Veera. <i>The Whole Story of Half a Girl</i>. Yearling. 2013. • Zindel, Paul. <i>The Pigman</i>. New York: HarperTrophy, 2005. Print. • Lowry, Lois. <i>The Giver</i>. Clarion Books; Reprint edition (July 1, 2014) • Gibson, William. <i>The Miracle Worker; and Related Readings</i>. Evanston, IL: McDougal Littell, 1998. Print. • L'Engle, Madeleine. <i>A Wrinkle in Time</i>: Square Fish; Reprint edition 2007. Print. • Christie, Agatha. <i>And Then There Were None</i>. New York: Harper, 2011. Print. • Shostak, Jerome. <i>Sadlier-Oxford Vocabulary Workshop New Edition Level B</i>. New ed. New York, NY: William H. Sadlier, 2005. Print. • https://www.ixl.com/ela/grade-7 IXL Grade 7 - various activities; one login per student and teacher |
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PLEASE NOTE: Any resource or material that falls outside of the approved lists included within the curriculum document must have administrative approval prior to use. These resources or materials must also be noted in the teacher's lesson plan after approval is granted.

Unit # 1	Duration (1 Marking Period)
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Topic: Elements of Literature and Narrative Writing

Alignment to NJSLs (include practice standards)

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • L.SS.7.1. • L.KL.7.2. • L.VL.7.3. • L.VI.7.4. • RL.CR.7.1. • RL.CI.7.2. • RL.PP.7.5. • W.AW.7.1. • W.NW.7.3. • W.WP.7.4. • W.RW.7.7. • SL.PE.7.1. • SL.AS.7.6. |
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Technology, Career Awareness, and 21st Century Standards (NJSL 9)

8.1.8.CS.4: Systematically apply troubleshooting strategies to identify and resolve hardware and software problems in computing systems.

8.1.8.DA.1: Organize and transform data collected using computational tools to make it usable for a specific purpose.

9.4.8.DC.1: Analyze the resource citations in online materials for proper use.

9.4.8.DC.2: Provide appropriate citation and attribution elements when creating media products (e.g., W.6.8).

Interdisciplinary Standards

RH.6-8.6. Identify aspects of a text that reveal an author's point of view or purpose (e.g., loaded language, inclusion or avoidance of particular facts).

Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)

SL.II.7.2. Analyze the main ideas and supporting details presented in diverse media and formats (e.g., visually, quantitatively, orally) and explain how the ideas clarify a topic, text, or issue under study.

Learning Objectives and Activities

SWBAT answer the following questions:

- How does understanding narrative structure improve our ability to analyze a story's meaning?
- How does close-reading help us identify and summarize the main ideas of stories?
- How does text evidence strengthen our literary analysis?
- Why are narrative elements, like plot, imagery, dialogue, and figurative language, important for writing strong text-based original stories?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

- **Narrative Analysis**
 - Elements of Fiction
 - Narrative Text Structure
 - Plot
 - Characterization
 - Setting (Direct/Indirect)
 - Conflict
 - Summarizing literal central ideas
 - Making Inferences
 - Determining meanings of figurative language
 - Identify and analyze elements of style: word choice, imagery, and dialogue
- **Open-Ended Response**
 - Paragraph Structure
 - Topic sentence
 - Supporting Details
 - Cited Textual Evidence
 - Extended Explanation

- Restate/Concluding Statement

- **Text-Based Narratives**

- Format
- Dialogue
- Plot Planning
- Sensory Details
- Text-Based Details
- Figurative Language
- Reflective Conclusions

Learning Activities:

- **Reading and Analyzing Narratives**

- Identify and analyze narrative text structure, elements of plot
- Discover and trace the development of topics, morals, and themes, as well as make sound inferences, and predictions in literature.
- Summarize literal and inferential central ideas in chronological order.
- Select accurate pieces of textual evidence to illustrate claim validity.
- Develop appropriate vocabulary and grammar for grade level

- **Open-Ended Responses**

- introduce/build on knowledge of paragraph structure: MLA format (signal phrase and parenthetical citations), topic sentence, supporting details, transitions, concluding statements/restatements.
- close read, highlight main ideas, and annotate prompts to gain clear understanding of what is specifically being asked.
- complete plans for organized writing using a variety of graphic organizers.
- gather and incorporate various appropriately cited pieces of textual evidence.
- summarize central ideas in chronological order.
- write short answer responses to open-ended questions that follow MLA format and include a clear thesis/topic sentence/answer and expanded explanation using relative, specific cited textual evidence.
- rainbow edit writing for introduction, thesis, support (cited textual evidence and inferences) format, transitions, conclusion
- routinely write short answer responses and allot time for reflection of strengths and weaknesses as well as peer and teacher feedback.

- **Planning and Writing Text-Based Narratives:**

- identify and apply elements of narrative writing.
- write narrative hooks.
- demonstrate normative dialogue structure.
- use and evenly distribute descriptive details: sensory details, imagery, characterization.
- plan and executing plot structure conflict/resolution around a central idea/theme.
- incorporate figurative language and appropriate use of grade-level modifiers, phrases, and clauses.
- appropriately incorporating text-based elements.
- write reflective conclusions that draw from the main character's experience.

- **Suggested Study Sync Units**
 - Unit 1
 - Parts of Unit 2
- **Suggested IXL Lessons**
 - 7.C.1. Identify the author's purpose
 - 7.F.1. Identify sensory details
 - 7.G.1. Identify the narrative point of view
 - 7.G.2. Draw inferences from literary texts
 - 7.G.3. Analyze short stories
 - 7.K. 3-4. Analyze passages from *A Night to Remember*
 - 7.P.1. Use personification
 - 7.P.2. Create varied sentences based on models
 - 7.P. 3. Revise the sentence using a stronger verb
 - 7.Q. 2. Identify supporting details in literary texts
 - 7.DD. 1-7. Sentences, Fragments, Run-ons

Benchmark, Formative, Summative and Alternative Assessments

- **Reading and Analyzing a Literary Text:**
 - **Evidence-Based Selected Response Forms Test:** Students will close read multiple choice questions and possible answer choices, literal and inferential claims and pieces of cited textual evidence, to conclude accurate text-based selections. Questions will focus on narrative text structure/plot, setting, characterization, conflict, point of view, narration, topics, morals, and themes, figurative language and vocabulary in context.
- **Written Expression Formal Assessments:**
 - **Open-Ended Questions:** Students will write a cohesive open-ended response about a narrative that uses appropriate textual evidence and extended explanation(s) to support their thesis/answer. Scoring: Assignment-based rubric
 - **Text-Based Narrative Story:** Given a narrative excerpt, students will prewrite, draft, and publish a narrative essay that illustrates appropriate genre-specific structure and dialogue, as well as sensory and accurate text-based details while maintaining a clear focus and flow according to the anchor text's plot and theme. Scoring: Assignment-based rubric
- **Summative:**
 - Quizzes, Short-Answer Questions
 - Tests & Essays
- **Formative:**
 - Classwork and Homework
 - IXL Practice
 - Teacher Observation
 - Class Discussion
 - Close-Reading and Annotating

Unit # 2	Duration (1 Marking Period)
Topic: Poetry and Drama Literary Analysis	
Alignment to NJSLS (include practice standards)	
• L.SS.7.1. • L.KL.7.2. • L.VI.7.4. • RL.CR.7.1. • RL.CI.7.2. • RL.IT.7.3. • RL.TS.7.4. • RL.PP.7.5. • RL.MF.7.6. • RL.CT.7.8. • W.AW.7.1. • W.WP.7.4. • W.RW.7.7. • SL.PE.7.1. • SL.II.7.2. • SL.PI.7.4. • SL.AS.7.6.	
Technology, Career Awareness, and 21st Century Standards (NJSLS 9)	
9.4.5.CT.1: Identify and gather relevant data that will aid in the problem-solving process (e.g., 2.1.5.EH.4, 4-ESS3-1, 6.3.5.CivicsPD.2). 8.1.8.DA.3: Identify the appropriate tool to access data based on its file format.	
Interdisciplinary Standards	
9.4.5.IML.1: Evaluate digital sources for accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance (e.g., Social Studies Practice - Gathering and Evaluating Sources).	
Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)	
9.4.8.DC.1: Analyze the resource citations in online materials for proper use.	
Learning Objectives and Activities	
SWBAT answer the following questions: ○ How does the use of figurative language, symbolism, theme, and sound devices in poetry shape its craft and structure? ○ How do the dramatic elements of a play contribute to its overall impact and meaning? ○ How does using five-paragraph essay structure help to demonstrate our understanding of a text?	

- How can tracking the development of a theme throughout a text deepen our understanding of the text's message?
- How can comparing and contrasting elements of a text help us understand an author's purpose?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

- **Poetry**
 - Craft and Structure of Poetry
 - Central Idea in Poetry
 - Determining Poetic Themes
 - Sound Devices
- **Literary Analysis**
 - Elements of Drama (Plays) and Reading Comprehension
 - Compare and Contrast
 - Five-Paragraph Essay Structure
 - Paragraph Structure
 - Thesis Writing
 - Direct Citation Usage (MLA)

Learning Activities:

- **Poetry Analysis**
 - Review and give notes on mood, tone, word choice, style, form, sound devices, narration, topic, and theme development in poetry.
 - Analyze the development and structure of various genres of poetry through close reading and annotating.
 - Identify and analyze the use of sound devices as they contribute to holistic meaning.
 - Demonstrate knowledge of figurative language and literary devices in poetry and drama.
 - Illustrate knowledge of theme development in poetry.
 - Use text-based evidence to explain central ideas in various forms of poetry.
 - Give an oral interpretation of a poem.
 - Make thematic connections between poetry, narrative, and drama.
- **Elements of Drama and Theme Development**
 - Identify and explain genre-specific terms (ex: stage directions, dialogue, etc.)
 - Identify and explain literary device terms and examples in context: allusion, flashback, foreshadowing, irony, and symbolism.
 - Determine universal themes and track their development in the text
- **Literary Analysis that Compares and Contrasts**
 - Review elements of fiction, particularly character development, theme, and symbolism by close reading various works of fiction (novels, short stories, poetry, excerpts, movies, etc.)
 - Given two works of fiction, use various types of prewriting (webs, t-charts, etc.) to compare and contrast elements of the stories (character, theme, symbolism, etc.) using strong direct citations.

- Given various works of fiction, have students compare and contrast elements of both stories by completing open-ended paragraphs using strong evidence from both texts to support their claims.
- Providing two or more works of fiction for each prompt, have students create essays that determine the development of character, theme, or symbolism, etc. by comparing and contrasting elements of each text in well-supported paragraphs.
- **Thesis Writing and Explanatory Five Paragraph Essay Structure**
 - Discuss elements of explanatory (expository) essay writing (introductions and thesis writing, body paragraphs, conclusions) by showing examples and writing as a class, in groups, and as individuals.
 - Review topic sentence writing for body paragraphs, emphasizing that each matches thesis statement (writing focus and flow) which reflects writing prompt.
 - Review usage of strong citations supporting topic sentences and thesis.
 - Teach students how to create and differentiate between simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences to help their writing sound more mature and avoid fragments (by correctly identifying independent and dependent clauses)
- **Written Expression: *Example-Interpreting a Poem***
 - Write a personal response to poems based on various prompts
 - Cite appropriate text-based details to support analysis of theme development or thesis
 - Compare and contrast different poetic forms and structures
- **Suggested Study Sync Units**
 - Unit 1
 - Parts of Unit 5
- **Suggested IXL Lessons**
 - 7.B.1. Match the quotations with their themes
 - 7.B.2. Determine the themes of short stories
 - 7.C.1. Identify author's purpose
 - 7.C.D. Determine the author's point of view
 - 7.F. 1-6 Literary devices
 - 7.G.4. Label the rhyme scheme
 - 7.N.1. Order topics from broadest to narrowest
 - 7.O.2. Identify thesis statements
 - 7.O.3. Choose evidence to support a claim
 - 7.R.3. Remove redundant words or phrases
 - 7.S.4. Correct errors in every day use
 - 7.Y.2. Positive and negative connotation
 - 7.AA.4. Use context to identify the meaning of a word
 - 7.DD. 1-7 Sentences, fragments, and run-ons
 - 7.EE. 1-5 Phrases and clauses

- **Compare and Contrast Open-Ended Response:**
 - Students will compare and contrast elements (character, plot, poetic devices, structure, etc.) within the same text by citing evidence for their claims.
- **Theme Development Essay Analysis of Single Text:**
 - Students will use a given fictional text and track how an author develops theme by close reading and by writing a five-paragraph explanatory essay using direct citations as evidence to their claims.
- **Summative:**
 - Quizzes
 - Tests and Essays
- **Formative:**
 - Classwork and Homework
 - IXL Practice
 - Teacher Observation
 - Class Discussion
 - Close-Reading and Annotating
 - Peer Editing and Revising Using Rubrics

Unit # 3	Duration (1 Marking Period)
Topic: Informational Text Analysis and Research	
Alignment to NJSLs (include practice standards)	
● L.SS.7.1. ● L.KL.7.2. ● L.VL.7.3. ● RI.CR.7.1. ● RI.CI.7.2. ● RI.IT.7.3. ● RI.TS.7.4. ● RI.PP.7.5. ● RI.AA.7.7. ● W.AW.7.1. ● W.IW.7.2. ● W.WP.7.4. ● W.WR.7.5. ● W.SE.7.6. ● W.RW.7.7. ● SL.PE.7.1. ● SL.II.7.2. ● SL.ES.7.3.	

- SL.PI.7.4.
- SL.UM.7.5.
- SL.AS.7.6.

Technology, Career Awareness, and 21st Century Standards (NJSL 9)

- **9.4.8.CT.1:** Evaluate diverse solutions proposed by a variety of individuals, organizations, and/or agencies to a local or global problem, such as climate change, and use critical thinking skills to predict which one(s) are likely to be effective (e.g., MS-ETS1-2).
- **8.1.8.DA.1:** Organize and transform data collected using computational tools to make it usable for a specific purpose.
- **9.4.8.DC.8:** Explain how communities use data and technology to develop measures to respond to effects of climate change (e.g., smart cities).

Interdisciplinary Standards

- **RST.6-8.1** Cite specific textual evidence to support analysis of science and technical texts, attending to the precise details of explanations or descriptions (MS-PS1-2), (MS-PS1-3)
- **WHST.6-8.7** Conduct short research projects to answer a question (including a self-generated question), drawing on several sources and generating additional related, focused questions that allow for multiple avenues of exploration. (MS-PS1-6)

Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)

SL.II.7.2. Analyze the main ideas and supporting details presented in diverse media and formats (e.g., visually, quantitatively, orally) and explain how the ideas clarify a topic, text, or issue under study.

W.SE.7.6. Gather relevant information from multiple print and digital sources, using search terms effectively; assess the credibility and accuracy of each source; and quote or paraphrase the data and conclusions of others while avoiding plagiarism and following a standard format for citation. Climate Change Example: Students may determine the credibility of multiple digital and print data sources that can be used as supporting evidence in constructing a model for describing the cycling of water through Earth's systems driven by energy from the sun and the force of gravity.

Learning Objectives and Activities

SWBAT answer the following questions:

- How does our understanding of text structure aid in our interpretation of informational text?
- When do writing responses require more than one direct citation?
- How can we avoid plagiarism when paraphrasing informational text?
- Why are citing from multiple sources an effective way to support our claims?
- How does using counterclaims in argumentative writing help strengthen our arguments?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

- Informational Text Structures
- Credible vs Non-Credible Source Differentiation
- Genre-Specific Vocabulary
- MLA Parenthetical Citations
- Differentiating Between Main Ideas, Supporting Details, and Extraneous Information
- Summary Writing

- Outline Writing
- Paraphrasing and Avoiding Plagiarism
- Transition Words/Phrases
- The Writing Process
- Research Paper Writing (5-paragraph essays)
- Research Simulation Tasks
- Persuasive vs Argumentative Writing
- Elements of Arguments
- Claims vs Counterclaims vs Rebuttals
- Debate Strategies
- Argumentative Essay Writing

Learning Activities:

- **Intro to Informational Text: Reading Comprehension**
 - Introduce informational text structures (thesis statements, main idea, supporting details, definitions, examples, etc.) and text features (headings, graphics, etc.). Utilize close-reading strategies to identify each.
 - Review how to differentiate between credible and non-credible sources and the difference between fact and opinion. Track author's purpose.
 - Identify meanings of words and phrases in a text and the impact of word choice on meaning and tone.
 - Introduce how to properly cite multiple sources using MLA format for future usage of parenthetical citations and student-created works cited pages.
- **Summary Writing of Informational Text**
 - Using various informational texts, review ways to differentiate between information that is most important (primary supporting details) and secondary or extraneous detail
 - Introduce formal outline writing using standard format (roman numerals, letters, numbers, etc) using short texts or cross-curricular articles supporting social studies and / or science topics.
 - Use parenthetical citation to keep track of where info is coming from.
 - Review summary writing using important evidence only. Show the difference between paraphrase, direct citation, and plagiarism while using parenthetical citations in MLA format. Have students use their outlines to help guide their writing.
 - Have students create short summaries of various non-fiction texts, first in isolation, then across multiple texts by emphasizing importance of topic sentences and paraphrasing important info that supports the overall main idea of texts. Again, use outlines to help organize and keep track of info and incorporate parenthetical citations.
- **Research Papers (Informational Essay Writing)**
 - Review proper usage of transition words and specific vocabulary, paying close attention to sentence structure and grammar usage. (Types of Sentences: simple, compound, complex sentences).
 - Using the parts of the writing process previously reviewed (see above), give students writing prompts that require them to read multiple informational texts in various forms (articles, info-graphs, videos, etc.) and create formal outlines, thesis statements, five-paragraph essays using parenthetical citations, and a works cited page. Assist them with each stage of the research and writing process as needed.
 - Create broad topic prompt and have students research their own information, create their own theses, and write a five-paragraph essay following MLA format that supports their claims.
 - Prepare for common assessment Research Simulation Task

- **Elements of Argumentative Non-Fiction**

- Using non-fiction texts with clear stances on a controversial topic, review main idea, thesis statements and author's purpose.
- Introduce vocabulary like claims, counterclaims, and rebuttals, and have students identify each within given non-fiction texts.
- Review elements of persuasive writing and differentiate between persuasive and argumentative technique (use of counterclaims, etc). Provide reading comprehension quizzes using multiple-choice and open-ended questions.

- **Argumentative Essay Writing**

- Alternate between practicing close-reading skills of non-fiction texts of contrasting stances and writing argumentative paragraphs analyzing main ideas and claims and counterclaims, emphasizing the use of counterarguments that match the claims made before disproving them with solid evidence that supports thesis.
- Using the parts of the writing process, give students writing prompts that require them to read multiple informational texts in various forms (articles, info-graphs, videos, etc.) that have clear contrasting points of view on a given topic and have them create formal outlines, thesis statements, five-paragraph essays using MLA parenthetical citations, and a works cited page. Assist them with each stage of the research and writing process as needed, emphasizing the use of claims, counterclaims, and rebuttals to create strong and clear arguments.

- **Suggested Study Sync Units**

- Unit 3
- Unit 4
- Parts of Unit 5

- **Suggested IXL Lessons**

- 7.C.2. Which sentence is more formal?
- 7.E.1-4 Text structure
- 7.H.1-3 Analyzing informational texts
- 7.I.1. Trace an argument
- 7.K.1-2 Analyze passages from *Anne Frank: The Diary of a Young Girl*
- 7.K.3-4 Analyze passages from *A Night to Remember*
- 7.M.2. Read graphic organizers
- 7.N.1-3 Expository Writing
- 7.O.1-4 Persuasive and opinion writing
- 7.Q.1. Identify supporting details in informational texts
- 7.T.1-5 Research skills
- 7.AA.5. Use academic vocabulary in context: informational
- 7.CC.1-5 Reference skills
- 7.RR.1-5 Commas
- 7.VV.1-4 Formatting

Benchmark, Formative, Summative and Alternative Assessments

- **Research Paper(s):** Students will be given informational essay prompts requiring them to read multiple fiction and non-fiction sources. Students will synthesize information and create a five-paragraph essay utilizing direct citations as evidence for their claims.
- **Research Simulation Task:** Students will be given three articles about a non-fiction topic and tasked with answering multiple-choice reading comprehension questions and writing a five-paragraph informational essay under a time limit.

- **Argumentative Essays:** Give students writing prompts that require them to read multiple informational texts in various forms (articles, info-graphs, videos, etc.) that have clear contrasting points of view on a given topic and have them create formal outlines, thesis statements, five-paragraph essays using parenthetical citations, and a works cited page.
 - Provide non-fiction texts paired with works of fiction, particularly novels, that provide historical context, background information, author's purpose, or thematic support.
 - Given a rubric, students will demonstrate their reading comprehension of multiple sources on a given topic by creating a five-paragraph argumentative essay supporting their stance on a controversial topic. They will follow the different steps of the writing process (outlining, drafting, self and peer editing, revision, and publishing a final product with a works cited page).
- **Summative:**
 - Quizzes/Quests
 - Topic Tests & Essays
- **Formative:**
 - Classwork and Homework
 - IXL Practice
 - Teacher Observation
 - Class Discussion
 - Close-Reading and Annotating
 - Peer Editing and Revising Using Rubrics
 - Debates

Unit # 4	Duration: 1 Marking Period
Topic: Cumulative Review and Comparison of All Genres	
Alignment to NJSLs (include practice standards)	
● L.SS.7.1. ● L.KL.7.2. ● L.VL.7.3. ● L.VI.7.4. ● RL.CR.7.1. ● RI.CR.7.1. ● RI.IT.7.3. ● RL.PP.7.5. ● RI.PP.7.5. ● RL.MF.7.6. ● RI.MF.7.6. ● RL.CT.7.8. ● RI.CT.7.8. ● W.AW.7.1.	

- W.IW.7.2.
- W.NW.7.3.
- W.RW.7.7.
- SL.PE.7.1.
- SL.PI.7.4.
- SL.AS.7.6.

Technology, Career Awareness, and 21st Century Standards (NJSLS 9)

9.4.8.CI.2: Repurpose an existing resource in an innovative way (e.g., 8.2.8.NT.3).

9.4.8.CT.2: Develop multiple solutions to a problem and evaluate short- and long-term effects to determine the most plausible option (e.g., MS-ETS1-4, 6.1.8.CivicsDP.1).

Interdisciplinary Standards

9.4.8.CI.3: Examine challenges that may exist in the adoption of new ideas (e.g., 2.1.8.SSH, 6.1.8.CivicsPD.2).

Curriculum Requirements (N.J.A.C. 6A:8, 6A:30)

SL.II.7.2. Analyze the main ideas and supporting details presented in diverse media and formats (e.g., visually, quantitatively, orally) and explain how the ideas clarify a topic, text, or issue under study. Climate Change Example: Students may present data on the impacts that climate change has on New Jersey to inform the development of related technologies.

Learning Objectives and Activities

SWBAT answer the following questions:

- Why does comparing texts across genres help us understand story structure?
- How does close reading help deepen our understanding of all genres and text types?
- How can support our inferences by citing from multiple types of text?
- What is the importance of a works cited page?
- In what way are fictional and informational texts related?

SWBAT demonstrate understanding of the following:

- **Reading Comprehension Cumulative Review**
 - Narratives and Fiction
 - Poetry
 - Informational Text and Structure
 - Argumentative Evaluations
 - Compare and Contrast Fiction and Non-Fiction Texts
- **Written Expression Cumulative Review**
 - Text-Based Narrative
 - Literary Analysis: Compare Theme Development in Contrasting Genres

- Research Simulation
- Evaluating Arguments

Learning Activities:

- **Literary Analysis that Compares and Contrasts**
 - Review elements of fiction, particularly character development, theme, and symbolism by close reading various works of fiction (novels, short stories, poetry, excerpts, movies, etc.)
 - Given two works of fiction, use various types of prewriting (webs, t-charts, etc.) to compare and contrast elements of the stories (character, theme, symbolism, etc.) using strong direct citations.
 - Given various works of fiction, have students compare and contrast elements of both stories by completing open-ended paragraphs using strong evidence from both texts to support their claims.
 - Providing two or more works of fiction for each prompt, have students create essays that determine the development of character, theme, or symbolism, etc. by comparing and contrasting elements of each text in well-supported paragraphs.
- **Cumulative Review of all Genres:**
 - Demonstrate comprehensive knowledge of reading: literature, informational, argumentative, drama, and poetry.
 - See above curriculum and review using various texts and prompts for cumulative skill-based assessment of the seventh grade year.
- **Close Reading Strategies:**
 - Identifying and highlighting central ideas (s), annotating
 - Deciphering unknown words in context using context clues and knowledge of word parts (roots, prefix, suffix)
 - Formulating questions, making predictions, connections, and inferences
 - Analyzing use of and determining meanings of sound devices, figurative language, literary devices, imagery, mood, and tone
- **Central Ideas and Supporting Details:**
 - Explicit
 - Inferential
 - Theme development
- **Vocabulary in Context:**
 - connotation
 - denotation
 - context clues
- **Socratic Discussion:**
 - Answer and generate questions about text to create a class discussion.
- **Written Expression Cumulative Review**
 - Explain the meanings of words and phrases in a text, including figurative and literary meanings and connotations
 - Describe how an author develops the point of view of the speaker
 - Demonstrate appropriate use of MLA format

- **Suggested Study Sync Units**
 - Unit 5
 - Unit 6
 - Parts of any previous units
- **Suggested IXL Lessons**
 - 7.B.1. Match quotations with their themes
 - 7.C.3. Compare passages for tone
 - 7.L.1. Compare information from two texts
 - 7.L.2. Compare two texts with different genres
 - 7.M.1. Compare illustrations of literary and historical subjects
 - 7.N.3. Remove the sentence that does not belong
 - 7.P.2. Create varied sentences based on models
 - 7.R.2. Use parallel structure
 - 7.R.3. Remove redundant words or phrases
 - 7.S.5. Suggest appropriate revisions
 - 7.V. 1-4 Greek and Latin Roots
 - 7.W.1. Choose the synonym
 - 7.W.2. Choose the antonym
 - 7.Z.1. Analogies
 - 7.Z.2. Analogies: challenge
 - 7.PP.1-3 Misplaced modifiers
 - 7.JJ. 1-3 Subject-verb agreement

Benchmark, Formative, Summative and Alternative Assessments

- **Compare and Contrast Essays & OERs:**
 - Providing two or more works of fiction for each prompt, have students create essays that determine the development of character, theme, or symbolism, etc. by comparing and contrasting elements of each text in well-supported paragraphs using direct citations.
- **Cumulative Yearly Review Reading Comprehension Assessment**
- **Reading and Analyzing Various Genres Evidence Based Selected Response Forms Test**
 - Students' knowledge of literary, poetic, dramatic, informational, and argumentative texts will be assessed through an EBSR (Evidence Based Selected Response) test. Questions will focus on skills accumulated throughout the seventh-grade year.
- **Cumulative Yearly Review Written Expression Assessment:**
 - For each task, students will close read writing prompts, highlight central ideas, create plans to gather and organize information, then draft, revise, edit, and publish responses with formal MLA headings, titles, and Works Cited pages demonstrating superior command of the writing process in various genres.
- **Text-Based Narrative:**
 - Given a narrative and a prompt, students will retell events of plot through different narration and point-of-view.
- **Theme Development Essay Analysis of Multiple Texts:**
 - Given different genres (narrative, poem, drama), students will identify a common theme in multiple texts and illustrate its contrasting development in each by acknowledging text structure and central ideas.
- **Evaluating Arguments:**

- Given multiple sources that illustrate contrasting viewpoints (texts, videos, blogs, graphs, etc.), students will evaluate the strength of each argument in a Power Point presentation.
- **Research Simulation Task:**
 - Given three sources on a topic, students must identify a comparative central idea and illustrate how each source uses contrasting evidence to develop it.
- **Summative:**
 - Quizzes
 - Tests and Essays
- **Formative:**
 - Classwork and Homework
 - Guided Practice Problems
 - IXL Practice
 - Teacher Observations
 - Class Discussion
 - Close-Reading and Annotating

Modifications (ML, Special Education, At Risk Students, Gifted & Talented, & 504 Plans)

ML

- Work toward longer passages as skills in English increase
- Use visuals
- Introduce key vocabulary before lesson
- Teacher models reading aloud daily
- Use of Bilingual Dictionary
- Guided notes and/or scaffold outline for written assignments

Supports for Students With IEPs:

- Allow extra time to complete assignments or tests
- Guided notes and/or scaffold outline for written assignments
- Work in a small group
- Allow answers to be given orally or dictated
- Use large print books, Braille, or e-books
- Follow all IEP modifications

At-Risk Students:

- Guided notes and/or scaffold outline for written assignments
- Introduce key vocabulary before lesson
- Work in a small group
- Lesson taught again using a differentiated approach
- Allow answers to be given orally or dictated
- Use visuals / anchor charts
- Leveled texts according to ability

Gifted and Talented:

- Create an enhanced set of introductory activities (e.g. advance organizers, concept maps, concept puzzles)
- Provide options, alternatives and choices to differentiate and broaden the curriculum
- Organize and offer flexible small group learning activities
- Provide whole group enrichment explorations
- Use center, stations, or contracts
- Organize integrated problem-solving simulations
- Propose interest-based extension activities
- Expose students to beyond level texts.

Supports for Students With 504 Plans:

- Follow all the 504 plan modifications
- Text to speech/audio recorded selections
- Amplification system as needed
- Leveled texts according to ability
- Fine motor skill stations embedded in rotation as needed
- Provide anchor charts with high frequency words and phonemic patterns